Attendees at the Bacardi NH7 Weekender music festival this weekend will get to party like it's 1999. Punjabi pop star Daler Mehndi will headline on Sunday, December 3; the same day, Hindi pop-rock band Euphoria will perform a special set celebrating 25 years since the release of their debut album *Dhoom*. They follow other Indi-pop acts such as Lucky Ali and Baba Sehgal to have performed at the event over the years.

According to Palash Sen, the founder and frontman of Euphoria, music from that era is currently riding a wave of nostalgia because unlike "[most of] the kind of songs being made now [in which] almost the same ideas are being repeated, there was so much experimentation in the '90s". He says, "Daler Mehndi, Lucky Ali, Junoon, Strings, Bombay Vikings, everybody was making different music."

Sen believes those acts made such an impression on their teenaged listeners back then that now that they're in their thirties or early forties, not only do they want the sound back,



Founder and frontman Palash Sen promises Euphoria's Weekender set will feature "some very interesting collaborations"



MUSIC

ROCK CITY

A new music festival ***Bandland*** *aims to reinstate Bengaluru as India's rock music capital*

Calling Bengaluru the rock music capital of India might evoke protests from fans in Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata and Shillong, but the garden city just got an edge over the others, thanks to Bandland. Bengaluru will serve as the home of the new annual rock festival, the inaugural edition of which will be held on December 16-17 at the Embassy Riding School.

Promoted and produced by BookMyShow Live, Bandland will feature four international and eight Indian acts that span long-running legends and present-day stars. British hard rock veterans Deep Purple and American alternative rock icons Goo Goo Dolls will headline a line-up that includes the US's The War on Drugs and Australia's Amyl and the Sniffers, both of which are currently festival favourites across the world. Among the Indian contingent are pioneers Parikrama and Thermal and a Quarter as well as alternative rock idols Parvaaz and The F16s.

Owen Roncon, the chief of business at the live entertainment division at BookMyShow, tells INDIA TODAY that the intention of launching Bandland was two-fold. "We wanted to do more in the Bengaluru market," says Roncon, who added that the company's portfolio has several pop and electronic music events, many of them in Mumbai, where "a little saturation happens". Mounting a celebration of rock in Bengaluru "felt natural" because "the live scene is really healthy and [it



